

Why YOU Want to Develop on Falcon

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Why Should I Care?

- Palm's first NEW platform since the Pilot 1000 back in 1996
- **Ease of use** and speed of a PDA
- **Connectivity** of a smartphone
- **Form factor** of ultramobile laptop
- **Hackability** of a Linux box :)



Our Own Take on Mobile Linux

- We built our own **Linux distribution**
- **2.4.21 kernel** with Palm-developed tweaks
- Runs on **ARM/XScale** hardware
- Lots of **standard libraries**
- Palm-developed **GUI and middleware**
- APIs are similar to Palm OS, but **more complete**, fewer **silly restrictions**.



Important Features

- Internal storage: **256MB** + CF slot
- RAM: **128MB** (system uses 24MB)
- External Storage: SD and USB
- **Wireless Networking** (802.11b or BT to Treo)
- Big **1024x600** screen with graphics accelerator
- Full-size **keyboard** and scroll wheel

LOTS OF FUN TO USE.

Kinds of Applications

- **OK**: text-mode apps
- **Better**: DirectFB / LiTE apps
- **Best**: HxUI apps
- **Not Supported**:
  - X Windows, Gnome/GTK+, Qt/KDE, OpenGL,.net, Java



Layering of a Typical App

- **Your code** Awesome Application
- **HxUI** forms, dialogs, graphics
- **Hx** messaging, timers, sounds
- **glib** data structures
- **glibc** standard C/C++ library



- You can do a lot of developing and tweaking **directly on** the device.
- **Easy to port** over libraries and code from other systems.
- Design for **scaled-up PDA** instead of tiny laptop
- **Way more open** than our older platforms



“The future of fun software development



…is Falcon!”

Ben Combee, 2007